Being a photogenic land of truly magnificent landscapes, architecture, and colorful people, Afghanistan has arrested the picturesque imagination at least since the First Anglo-Afghan War (1839–1841) (Figure I.19), continuing to do so into the Second Anglo-Afghan War (1879–1881) (Figure I.20) with the great popularization of photographic technology as a tool to "visit" distant and exotic lands without the inconvenience and risk of actual travel. This fascination with Afghanistan seemed to persist during the first eight decades of the twentieth century, as archaeologists and other scholars undertook more systematic surveys and studies. These latter works included the invaluable archive of photographs left by the intrepid Josephine Powell (1919–2007) (Figure I.21).[56] Throughout more than a century of depiction, Afghanistan's lofty ruins and nomadic populations appear unchanging (compare Figures I.21 and I.22), always furnishing aesthetically evocative subjects begging to be Orientalized. I myself could not help but capture the wide-open plains edged by mountains outside the



Figure I.22 *Shahr-i Gholghola, general view, citadel (eleventh–thirteenth century), with women in foreground. © Photograph Josephine Powell* c. *1960. Harvard Fine Arts Library, Special Collections.*